

Participant Information Sheet: Plain Language Statement	
Study title and Researcher Details	
Title	Useful learning resources for Masters students
Researcher	Dr David Hodge
Department	School of Mathematics and Statistics
Invitation	
You are being invited to take part in a research study. Before you decide it is important for you to understand why the research is being done and what it will involve. Please take time to read the following information carefully and discuss it with others if you wish. Ask us if there is anything that is not clear or if you would like more information. Take time to decide whether or not you wish to take part. Thank you for reading this.	
What is the purpose of the study?	
To investigate which resources students have used and found useful for their learning as part of their learning in MATH5085 (Data Analysis Skills) and MATH5098 (Advanced Predictive Models). Outcomes can provide insights into which resources to focus on updating and developing further, as well as aiming to improve efficient use of both student and staff time.	
Why have I been chosen?	
All students on the Statistics and Data Science MScs programmes at the University of Glasgow are invited to participate. Participation from as many students as possible is desired. Students who didn't use Moodle very much are very welcome.	
Do I have to take part?	
It is up to you to decide whether or not to take complete the survey. If you decide to take part, you are still free to withdraw without giving a reason. Participating or not participating will have no effect on your grades in any way. After completing the survey you will still be able to withdraw up until course grades have been linked and the data anonymised (which will occur soon after June 2026 exam boards or the closing of the survey, whichever is later).	
What will happen to me if I take part?	
You will be provided a link to an online survey. There you will be asked to agree to provide consent to participate and then be presented with a series of questions. Once you have completed the survey your participation is complete. The survey is expected to take around SIX minutes to complete. After your semester 2 courses are complete, exams have been taken and fully marked, your course marks from these two course will be linked in the anonymised data to assist with drawing insights. At the moment that an exam mark is associated with a survey student anonymisation will be performed.	
Will my taking part in this study be kept confidential?	
Please note that assurances on confidentiality will be strictly adhered to unless evidence of wrongdoing or potential harm is uncovered. In such cases the University may be obliged to contact relevant statutory bodies/agencies. Note, no activity classified as wrongdoing or harmful is asked about during the survey.	

In addition, any identifiable record of your individual participation will be kept only as long as strictly necessary to collate data and answer the research aims of this project. After which any identifiable records will be anonymised.

What will happen to the project data and the results of the research study?

All collected survey data will be securely stored and held in accordance with the General Data Protection Regulation (2018). Your data will form part of the study results that may be published in expert journals, presentations, and on the internet for other researchers to use. As such the data may necessarily be archived for the purposes of scientific research. This data may also be used to motivate changes to future learning resources. Personal and identifiable information will either be anonymised or deleted and will therefore not appear in any publication.

The consent form you agree to will contain a clear explanation that anonymisation will occur upon linking survey data with course grades. As such individuals will not be able to perform data withdrawal afterwards, since their responses will no longer be identifiable.

Who has reviewed the study?

Materials relating to the study have been reviewed and approved by members of the SoTL Research Ethics Committee.

Application reference number:

#111

Date of approval letter:

29/05/2026

How can I access information relating to me or complain if I suspect information has been misused/ used for purposes other than I agreed to?

You can contact the researcher in the first instance if you have any concerns. If you are not comfortable doing this, or if you have tried but don't get a response or if the person in question appears to have left the University, you can contact the SoTL Ethics Officer (email: sotlethics@glasgow.ac.uk).

Where there appear to have been problems, you can – and indeed may be advised to – submit an 'access request' or an objection to the use of data. As part of the University's obligations under UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR), participants retain the rights to access and objection with regard to the use of non-anonymised data for research purposes.

1. Access requests and objections can be submitted via the UofG online proforma accessible at: <https://www.gla.ac.uk/myglasgow/dpfoioffice/informationrequests/datasubjectrights/>.
2. Access requests and objection are formal procedures not because we mean to intimidate participants into not raising issues, but rather because the University is legally required to respond and address concerns. The system provides a clear point of contact, appropriate support and a clear set of responsibilities.
3. Anyone who submits a request will need to provide proof of their identity. Again, this is not to deter inquiries, but rather reflects the University's duty to guard against fraudulent approaches that might result in data breaches.
4. You also have the right to lodge a complaint against the University regarding data protection issues with the Information Commissioner's Office ([Make a complaint | ICO](#)).

Privacy Notice for Participation in Research Project: Useful learning resources for Masters students**Your Personal Data**

The University of Glasgow will be what's known as the 'Data Controller' of your personal data processed in relation to your participation in the research project **Useful learning resources for Masters students**. This privacy notice will explain how The University of Glasgow will process your personal data.

Why we need it

We are collecting basic personal data such as your name and contact details in order to conduct our research. We need your name and contact details to arrange a **survey** and potentially follow up on the data you have provided.

We only collect data that we need for the research project and will de-identify your personal data from your answers given during the **survey** through **pseudonymisation**.

Please note that your confidentiality may be impossible to guarantee for example due to the size of the participant group, location etc. Please see accompanying **Participant Information Sheet**.

Legal basis for processing your data

We must have a legal basis for processing all personal data. As this processing is for Academic Research, we will be relying upon **Task in the Public Interest** in order to process the basic personal data that you provide. For any special categories data collected we will be processing this on the basis that it is **necessary for archiving purposes, scientific or historical research purposes or statistical purposes**.

Alongside this, in order to fulfil our ethical obligations, we will ask for your **agreement** to take part in the study Please see accompanying **Participant Agreement Form** (consent to participate).

What we do with it and who we share it with

All the personal data you submit is processed by (Dr David Hodge) who is a member of staff at the University of Glasgow in the United Kingdom. In addition, security measures are in place to ensure that your personal data remains safe: we will use pseudonyms and remove any personally identifying information, and keep all data on secure UofG OneDrive storage, accessible only to the researcher(s). Please consult the **Participant Agreement Form** and **Participant Information Sheet** which accompany this notice.



How long do we keep it for?

Your **personal** data will be retained by the University only for as long as is necessary for processing and no longer than the period of ethical approval. After this time, personal data will be securely deleted.

Your **research** data will be retained for a period of ten years in line with the University of Glasgow Guidelines. Specific details in relation to research data storage are provided on the Participant Information Sheet and Participant Agreement Form which accompany this notice.

What are your rights?

GDPR provides that individuals have certain rights including: to request access to, copies of and rectification or erasure of personal data and to object to processing. In addition, data subjects may also have the right to restrict the processing of the personal data and to data portability. You can request access to the information we process about you at any time.

If at any point you believe that the information we process relating to you is incorrect, you can request to see this information and may in some instances request to have it restricted, corrected, or erased. You may also have the right to object to the processing of data and the right to data portability.

Please note that as we are processing your personal data for research purposes, the ability to exercise these rights may vary as there are potentially applicable research exemptions under the GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018. For more information on these exemptions, please see [UofG Research with personal and special categories of data](#).

If you wish to exercise any of these rights, please submit your request via the [webform](#) or contact dp@gla.ac.uk

Complaints

If you wish to raise a complaint on how we have handled your personal data, you can contact the University Data Protection Officer who will investigate the matter.

Our Data Protection Officer can be contacted at dataprotectionofficer@glasgow.ac.uk

If you are not satisfied with our response or believe we are not processing your personal data in accordance with the law, you can complain to the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) <https://ico.org.uk/>

Who has ethically reviewed the project?

This project has been ethically approved via the Scholarship of Teaching and Learning Research Ethics Committee.

End of Privacy Notice _____